

Module 13: Cities, Communities, and Integration

Graduate Research Project

What Makes Integration Work? Evaluating a Model and Designing an Intervention

Overview

Evaluate one urban integration model (e.g., sanctuary services, municipal ID programs, community sponsorship, refugee-led organizations) against the evidence, then design a community-based intervention with a full evaluation logic model.

Aligned learning outcomes

- Design community-based interventions (Grad 1)
- Evaluate integration models (Grad 2)

Sample research questions

- What does your chosen model claim to change, and what does the evidence actually show?
- Which conditions (governance, funding, community leadership) explain where it succeeds and fails?
- What would a locally-adapted intervention look like, and how would you evaluate it credibly?

Methods

Evaluation synthesis of published studies plus city-level documentary analysis; intervention design with logic model (inputs → activities → outcomes), indicators, and comparison logic. Optional key-informant interviews (IRB required).

IRB / research ethics

Not required for documentary design; required for interviews.

Deliverables

- 4,500-word model evaluation
- Intervention design with logic model figure
- Evaluation plan (indicators, data sources, timeline)

Grading rubric

Each criterion is scored at one of four levels, then weighted as shown. The overall grade is the weighted combination of criterion scores. Instructors may adapt weights and descriptors to local requirements.

Criterion (weight)	Exemplary (A)	Proficient (B)	Developing (C)	Beginning (D–F)
Honesty of the evidence assessment 30%	Evidence and accuracy are exemplary: honesty of the evidence assessment is met with high-quality, correctly cited sources for every substantive claim; terms, facts, and frameworks are used precisely.	Evidence and accuracy are solid: honesty of the evidence assessment is met for nearly all claims, with only minor sourcing gaps or imprecisions that do not affect conclusions.	Evidence and accuracy are uneven: honesty of the evidence assessment is partly met — some claims lack support, sources are thin or misread, or terms are used loosely in ways that weaken conclusions.	Evidence and accuracy are deficient: honesty of the evidence assessment is not met; key claims are unsupported or wrong, and errors undermine the work's conclusions.
Fit of intervention to local context 25%	Design judgment is excellent: fit of intervention to local context is fully addressed — costs, constraints, politics, and failure modes are named honestly and the proposal remains workable anyway.	Design judgment is good: fit of intervention to local context is addressed for the major factors, with minor blind spots that would not sink the proposal.	Design judgment is limited: fit of intervention to local context is addressed superficially — key constraints or failure modes are ignored, making the proposal fragile.	Design judgment is missing: fit of intervention to local context is not addressed; the proposal ignores obvious constraints and would not survive contact with reality.
Rigor of the logic model and evaluation plan 30%	Method is rigorous and transparent: rigor of the logic model and evaluation plan is fully documented, choices are justified, limitations are stated, and another student could replicate the work from what is written.	Method is sound: rigor of the logic model and evaluation plan is documented and mostly justified, with limitations acknowledged; small gaps would not change the findings.	Method is partial: rigor of the logic model and evaluation plan is described but under-documented or inconsistently applied, leaving findings plausible but not checkable.	Method is absent or unsound: rigor of the logic model and evaluation plan is missing, undocumented, or applied so loosely that the findings cannot be trusted.
Clarity 15%	Communication is publication-ready: clarity is achieved with precise, well-organized prose, correct citation, and figures or formats that make the argument easier to grasp.	Communication is clear and professional: clarity is achieved with minor lapses in polish, organization, or citation that never obscure meaning.	Communication is understandable but rough: clarity is only partly achieved — disorganization, citation errors, or unclear figures make the reader work to follow the argument.	Communication impedes the work: clarity is not achieved; errors, disorganization, or missing citations obscure the substance.